

Controlled Environment Agriculture (CEA) operators build the picture of their new operations with models that have their best estimates of new workflows, staffing needs, and forecast throughputs. By necessity, those projections drive procurement decisions before they can be validated against how the facility will actually run. It's a natural part of the process, but by the time equipment arrives on site, gaps between their starting assumptions and the reality of implementation are already baked in. The downstream costs of closing those gaps end up falling on the vendor as much as the operator, causing commissioning delays, change orders, scope disputes, and post-installation support burdens that were never part of the original sale.

My job is to help close those gaps before they become a burden to the timeline and end result.

WHERE THE GAPS TYPICALLY LIVE

OPERATIONAL PLANNING

- Workflow design
- Throughput & unit economics
- Food safety systems

PHYSICAL SYSTEMS

- Seeding & growing
- Harvesting & packaging
- HVAC, lighting, & irrigation

INFRASTRUCTURE & EXECUTION

- Software platform selection
- Systems integration
- Operational SOPs

WHERE I CAN HELP

PRE-SALES ADVISORY SUPPORT

Your customer has questions you can't fully answer — not about equipment capability, but about how the equipment fits their specific operation: workflow implications, staffing requirements, upstream and downstream process changes, integration with existing systems. I give an operator-side perspective at the pre-sales stage to help guide customers toward better buying decisions.

- Better upfront customer decisions
- Operational understanding your competitors won't have
- Cleaner handoff from sale to installation

INTEGRATION GAP ANALYSIS

An operator often hasn't worked through everything their operation needs to have ready to support your equipment. My role is to close that gap — surfacing the right requirements, thinking through upstream and downstream implications, and arriving at a well-defined picture of what's needed before you quote and deliver it.

- Cleaner requirements, less back-and-forth
- Compressed timeline to confirmed scope
- Fewer change orders and scope disputes

DIFFERENTIATED SALES PRESENCE

A vendor who arrives at a sales conversation with someone who understands the customer's production economics, workflow implications, and operational realities beyond the solution spec is demonstrating an understanding most competitors won't have. That's a different kind of sales conversation, and it's a harder one to walk away from.

- Value-add most competitors can't offer
- Shifts the conversation from spec to operational fit
- Builds credibility that outlasts the sales cycle

POST-INSTALL RECOVERY

When a customer engagement starts hitting snags — performance gaps, integration problems, operator adoption issues — having a resource who understands the operator-side perspective can assess what's actually happening quickly and get things back on track. An operator-side diagnosis, not a support queue.

- Faster root cause diagnosis
- Clearer path to resolution
- Better outcomes for you and your customer

BACKGROUND & EXPERIENCE

I've spent over a decade in the Controlled Environment Agriculture industry at Vertical Harvest. I started this part of my career inside their small-scale multi-crop facility in Jackson, Wyoming — from founding board member and general business consultant, to joining the company full-time in 2016 as a key executive alongside the co-founders.

Like leaders in most startups, I held many roles over time. As CFO I provided financial leadership and gained a deep understanding of the critical cost drivers and unit economics of the business. As Director of Farm Systems I served as technical systems lead, where I led the re-think, re-design, and upgrade of existing operational and growing systems.

In my final role as Chief of Farm Systems, I served as the operator-side systems lead for the design and build-out of their large-scale automated facility in Maine — one of the more highly automated CEA facilities built in North America, designed for space and labor efficiency. I coordinated expert vendor and internal teams across every major discipline. I was responsible for all final equipment and software purchase selections, and had design oversight for how all the pieces fit together operationally. Throughout, I built and applied production economics models for the live operation to understand and project unit costs, yield prediction, process flow analysis, and projection-to-actual tracking.

VerdantTech Solutions is the independent consulting practice built on that background.

ENGAGEMENT MODEL

I can structure the work however best fits your situation: as embedded support under your banner, representing you directly to your customer; as a named independent contractor, engaged and paid by you; or as a direct referral, with the customer engaging VerdantTech separately. All three are available. We can work out the exact structure, representation, and applicable customer disclosures that make the most sense for you.

The right starting point is a conversation about where the friction is in your sales or integration process.

LET'S TALK